California vs. Texas: Two Different Americas?

Target Audience: B1+ / B2
Time: 45-50 minutes
Approach: CLIL + Socio-cultural approach
Lesson Objectives:

- Educational: Understand the cultural, geographical, and political differences between the US East Coast (represented by California) and the South (represented by Texas).
- Linguistic: Practice vocabulary related to lifestyle, geography, and politics (e.g., *coastal, conservative, liberal, stereotype, lifestyle*).
- Socio-cultural: Develop cultural sensitivity by breaking regional stereotypes and comparing regional differences in the US with regional differences in the students' home country (Dialogue of Cultures).

Stage	Stage aim	Timing	Procedure	Aids and materials
Warm-up	Activate background knowledge and introduce the concept of regional stereotypes.	5 min	Teacher shows two images: a sunny beach with palm trees (California) and a cowboy on a horse with an oil rig (Texas). Ask: *"Which state is this? What words come to mind when you think of California? What about Texas?"* Write ideas on the board.	Pictures of California and Texas.
Controlled Practice	Pre-teach vocabulary for the video.	7 min	Match words with definitions: *coastal, conservative, liberal, lifestyle, stereotype.*	Presentation slide
Viewing	Develop listening/viewing skills for general understanding and specific details.	10 min	Students watch the short video "Couple Moves to Texas Expecting to Be Richer… They Weren't". Question: *Why did the couple think they would be richer in Texas, and what did they discover?* (Answer:	Authentic video clip, table I Left Los A… (11:50-16:00), Couple Mov…

			No state income tax, but higher property taxes, insurance, and utilities). Students watch a fragment from "I Left Los Angeles" (Jhánneu). While watching, they fill in the table (Handout 2) comparing the Cost of Living and Lifestyle between California and Texas.	
Post-Viewing	Develop critical thinking and break down stereotypes.	8 min	Discuss: *"Are all Texans cowboys? Are all Californians surfers? Why are these stereotypes dangerous?"*	Presentation slide
Freer Practice	Apply knowledge, develop critical thinking through the "Dialogue of Cultures" (Safonova).	15 min	Role-Play "Relocation Agency". Group work. Students are relocation agents. A client is moving to the US but can't decide between California and Texas. They must create a "client profile" (e.g., a vegan artist, a conservative businessman, a retired couple) and present the best state for them, explaining why. Task 2: Dialogue of Cultures. Discuss: *"Does your country have strong regional differences (e.g., North vs. South, East vs. West)? How are people from these regions stereotyped?"*	Relocation Template
Homework and feedback	Summarize and reflect.	5 min	Reflection: *"Why is it important to look beyond regional stereotypes?"* Homework: Write a short paragraph (50 words): *"What is the biggest stereotype about your region/city? Is it true?"*	Notebooks

Match the words (1-5) with their definitions (A-E).

Word	Letter	Definition
1. Coastal	[ ]	A. A way of living (including habits, attitudes, and possessions).
2. Conservative	[ ]	B. Located near the sea or ocean.
3. Liberal	[ ]	C. A fixed idea about a group of people that is often not true.
4. Lifestyle	[ ]	D. Holding traditional values; not liking sudden changes (often associated with right-wing politics).
5. Stereotype	[ ]	E. Open to new ideas and changes; progressive (often associated with left-wing politics).

1. B
2. D
3. E
4. A
5. C

Watch the two videos and complete the table.

Feature	California (from the videos)	Texas (from the videos)
Rent / Mortgage		

Taxes

Lifestyle (space, pace of life)

Overall Conclusion

Discussion Question after viewing:
Did the couple from the Shorts and the girl from the Vlog have the same experience in Texas? Why or why not?
(Expected answer: No. The girl was happy because she got more space for the same rent. The couple was unhappy because other expenses like property tax were higher than they expected).

Situation: You work for "US Relocation Agency". Your client wants to move to the US but cannot decide between California and Texas.

Step 1: Choose a client profile from the list below (or create your own):

- *Client A:* A 25-year-old vegan software engineer who loves surfing and hates cold weather.
- *Client B:* A 50-year-old conservative businessman who loves hunting, big cars, and low taxes.
- *Client C:* A retired couple who want a quiet life, warm weather, and a low cost of living.

Step 2: Recommend a state for your client and write 3 reasons for your choice.

Client: _____
Recommended State: _____

Reasons:

1. _____